Coimisiún na Scrúduithe Stáit
State Examinations Commission

LEAVING CERTIFICATE EXAMINATION, 2021

ANCIENT GREEK — HIGHER LEVEL

(280 marks)

TIME: 3 Hours

MONDAY, 21 JUNE – MORNING 9.30 – 12.30

The 2021 examination papers were adjusted to compensate for disruptions to learning due to COVID-19. This examination paper does not necessarily reflect the same structure and format as the examination papers of past or subsequent years.

1. Answer Section A **or** Section B:- **[50]**

A. Translate into Greek:-

Messengers said that the enemy were coming with a very large army. For a long time the citizens deliberated. "Must we stay here and fight," they asked, "or flee and give our city to the enemy?" Finally they decided to obey the wisest of the citizens. "Although loving our city," he said, "let us leave it. Send the women and children to the islands. We ourselves must go onto the ships, in order to fight the enemy by sea. For only if we leave our city will we be able to save it."

I deliberate: βουλεύομαι.

OR

B. Read the following passage and answer, in English, all the questions which follow:-

(Cyrus the Great, king of Persia, is about to lead his army against the Armenian king, who has not kept his promises. But first Cyrus sends him a message.)

Κῦρος δ᾽ ἄγγελον προύπεμπε πρὸς τὸν ᾽Αρμένιον, εἰπὼν αὐτῷ λέγειν ὧδε·

‘ “Κῦρος, ὦ ᾽Αρμένιε, κελεύει σε ὡς τάχιστα φέρειν καὶ τὸν δασμὸν καὶ τὸ στράτευμα.” ἢν δ᾽ ἐρωτᾷ ὅπου εἰμί, λέγε τὰ ἀληθῆ, ὅτι ἐπὶ τοῖς ὁρίοις. ἢν δ᾽ ἐρωτᾷ εἰ καὶ αὐτὸς ἔρχομαι, λέγε καὶ ἐνταῦθα τὰ ἀληθῆ, ὅτι οὐκ οἶσθα. ἐὰν δὲ πυνθάνηται ὁπόσοι ἐσμέν, συμπέμπειν τινὰ κέλευε καὶ μαθεῖν.’

τὸν μὲν δὴ ἄγγελον ἔπεμψε, νομίζων φιλικώτερον οὕτως εἶναι ἢ μὴ προειπόντα πορεύεσθαι. ὁ δὲ ᾽Αρμένιος, ὡς ἤκουσε τοῦ ἀγγέλου τὰ παρὰ Κύρου, ἐξεπλάγη, ἐννοήσας ὅτι αὐτὸς ἀδικοίη καὶ τὸν δασμὸν καὶ τὸ στράτευμα οὐ πέμπων. ἀθροίζων οὖν τὴν ἑαυτοῦ δύναμιν, ἔπεμπεν εἰς τὰ ὄρη τὸν νεώτερον υἱὸν καὶ τὰς γυναῖκας (τήν τε ἑαυτοῦ καὶ τὴν τοῦ υἱοῦ), καὶ τὰς θυγατέρας· καὶ κόσμον δὲ καὶ κατασκευὴν τὴν πλείστου ἀξίαν συναπέπεμπε, προπομποὺς δοὺς αὐτοῖς.

᾽Αρμένιος: Armenian.
δασμός: tribute.
τὰ ὅρια: the frontier.
φιλικός: friendly.
ἐκπλήσσω: I strike with panic.
ἐννοέω: I consider, reflect.
ἀθροίζω: I muster, collect.
κόσμος: jewellery.
κατασκευή: furniture.
προπομπός: escort, protector.

(*a*) What command is the messenger to give to the Armenian from Cyrus? (6)

(*b*) How should the messenger respond if the Armenian asks where Cyrus is and if he is coming in person? (6)

(*c*) What should the messenger say if the Armenian wants to know how many men Cyrus has? (6)

(*d*) Why does Cyrus send this message to the Armenian? (7)

(*e*) On receiving the message, what is the Armenian's reflection on his own behaviour? (7)

(*f*) How is it clear that the Armenian intends to fight Cyrus? (6)

(*g*) Whom does the Armenian send to the mountains? (6)

(*h*) What does the Armenian send along with them? What precaution does he take? (6)

2. Translate into English **one** passage from **either** Section A **or** Section B:- **[90]**

A.

(i) *(While the Peloponnesians gather at the Isthmus of Corinth prior to invading Attica, Pericles son of Xanthippus gives the Athenians the same advice that he had previously given them concerning how to proceed in the present circumstances.)*

ἔτι δὲ τῶν Πελοποννησίων ξυλλεγομένων τε ἐς τὸν Ἰσθμὸν καὶ ἐν ὁδῷ ὄντων, πρὶν ἐσβαλεῖν ἐς τὴν Ἀττικήν, Περικλῆς ὁ Ξανθίππου, στρατηγὸς ὢν Ἀθηναίων, ἔγνω τὴν ἐσβολὴν ἐσομένην· παρήνει οὖν τοῖς Ἀθηναίοις περὶ τῶν παρόντων ἅπερ καὶ πρότερον, παρασκευάζεσθαί τε ἐς τὸν πόλεμον καὶ τὰ ἐκ τῶν ἀγρῶν ἐσκομίζεσθαι ἐς τὴν πόλιν, ἔς τε μάχην μὴ ἐπεξιέναι, ἀλλὰ τὴν πόλιν ἐσελθόντας φυλάσσειν, καὶ τὸ ναυτικόν, ᾗπερ ἰσχύουσιν, ἐξαρτύεσθαι, τά τε τῶν ξυμμάχων διὰ χειρὸς ἔχειν.

οἱ δὲ Ἀθηναῖοι ἀκούσαντες ἀνεπείθοντό τε καὶ ἐσεκομίζοντο ἐκ τῶν ἀγρῶν παῖδας καὶ γυναῖκας καὶ τὴν κατασκευὴν ᾗ κατ᾽ οἶκον ἐχρῶντο, καὶ αὐτῶν τῶν οἰκιῶν καθαιροῦντες τὴν ξύλωσιν· πρόβατα δὲ καὶ ὑποζύγια ἐς τὴν Εὔβοιαν διεπέμψαντο.

THUCYDIDES (90)

ξυλλέγομαι: I gather, assemble.
παρασκευάζομαι: I prepare.
ἐξαρτύομαι: I equip, get ready.
κατασκευή: furniture.
πρόβατον: sheep.
παραινέω (+ Dative Case): I advise.
ᾗπερ: in which.
ξύμμαχος: ally.
καθαιρέω: I pull down.
ὑποζύγιον: draught-animal.
ἰσχύω: I am strong.
διὰ χειρὸς: under control.
ξύλωσις: woodwork.

OR

(ii) *(Socrates must die on the day after the return of the Sacred Ship to Athens from its mission to Delos. Crito arrives early at the prison to tell him that the ship will be back that very day. Socrates, although not disturbed if Crito's news is true, does not think it is so.)*

ΣΩ. ἀλλὰ τί δὴ πρῲ ἀφῖξαι σύ;

ΚΡ. ἀγγελίαν, ὦ Σώκρατες, φέρων χαλεπήν, οὐ σοί, ὡς ἐμοὶ φαίνεται, ἀλλ᾽ ἐμοὶ καὶ τοῖς σοῖς ἐπιτηδείοις πᾶσιν καὶ χαλεπὴν καὶ βαρεῖαν.

ΣΩ. τίνα ταύτην; ἢ τὸ πλοῖον ἀφῖκται ἐκ Δήλου, οὗ δεῖ ἀφικομένου τεθνάναι με;

ΚΡ. οὗτοι δὴ ἀφῖκται, ἀλλὰ δοκεῖ μοι ἥξειν τήμερον ἐξ ὧν ἀπαγγέλλουσιν ἥκοντές τινες ἀπὸ Σουνίου καὶ καταλιπόντες ἐκεῖ αὐτό. δῆλον οὖν ἐκ τούτων ὅτι ἥξει τήμερον, καὶ ἀνάγκη δὴ εἰς αὔριον ἔσται, ὦ Σώκρατες, τὸν βίον σε τελευτᾶν.

ΣΩ. ἀλλ᾽, ὦ Κρίτων, τύχῃ ἀγαθῇ, εἰ ταύτῃ τοῖς θεοῖς φίλον ἐστί, ταύτῃ ἔστω· οὐ μέντοι οἶμαι ἥξειν αὐτὸ τήμερον. τεκμαίρομαι δὲ ἔκ τινος ἐνυπνίου ὃ ἑώρακα ὀλίγον πρότερον ταύτης τῆς νυκτός.

PLATO (90)

πρῴ: early.
ἐπιτήδειος: close friend.
τεθνάναι = τεθνηκέναι.
Σούνιον: Sunium (a headland in southern Attica).
εἰς αὔριον: tomorrow.
τελευτάω: I end.
τύχη: fortune, chance, luck.
ταύτῃ: in this way, so.
τεκμαίρομαι: I judge.
ἐνύπνιον: dream.

OR

B.

(i) *(Jocasta recalls how, when her husband was dead, her son Oedipus married her as the reward for solving the riddle of the Sphinx, became king of Thebes, and had four children by her — Eteocles, Polynices, Ismene, and Antigone.)*

ὡς δ᾽ ἐπεζάρει
Σφὶγξ ἁρπαγαῖσι πόλιν ἐμός τ᾽ οὐκ ἦν πόσις,
Κρέων ἀδελφὸς ταὰμὰ κηρύσσει λέχη,
ὅστις σοφῆς αἴνιγμα παρθένου μάθοι,
τούτῳ ξυνάψειν λέκτρα. τυγχάνει δέ πως
μούσας ἐμὸς παῖς Οἰδίπους Σφιγγὸς μαθών·
καὶ σκῆπτρ᾽ ἔπαθλα τῆσδε λαμβάνει χθονός.
γαμεῖ δὲ τὴν τεκοῦσαν οὐκ εἰδὼς τάλας
οὐδ᾽ ἡ τεκοῦσα παιδὶ συγκοιμωμένη.
τίκτω δὲ παῖδας παιδὶ δύο μὲν ἄρσενας,
Ἐτεοκλέα κλεινήν τε Πολυνείκους βίαν,
κόρας τε δισσάς· τὴν μὲν Ἰσμήνην πατὴρ
ὠνόμασε, τὴν δὲ πρόσθεν Ἀντιγόνην ἐγώ.

EURIPIDES (90)

ἐπιζαρέω: I oppress. ἁρπαγή: plundering. ταὰμά = τὰ ἐμά.
λέχος: marriage-bed. αἴνιγμα: riddle.
ξυνάπτω: I unite (Accusative Case) with (Dative Case). λέκτρον: marriage-couch.
μοῦσα: song. σκῆπτρον: sceptre, staff of kingship.
ἔπαθλον: prize. χθών = γῆ. τάλας: wretched.
συγκοιμάομαι (+ Dative Case): I sleep with. ἄρσην: male.
κλεινός: glorious. βία: power, might. δισσός = δύο.
τὴν … πρόσθεν: the elder.

OR

(ii) (*Thetis speaks about the life and current situation of Achilles, her son by Peleus.)*

υἱὸν ἐπεί μοι δῶκε γενέσθαι τε τραφέμεν τε,
ἔξοχον ἡρώων (ὁ δ᾽ ἀνέδραμεν ἔρνεϊ ἶσος),
τὸν μὲν ἐγὼ θρέψασα φυτὸν ὡς γουνῷ ἀλωῆς,
νηυσὶν ἐπιπροέηκα κορωνίσιν Ἴλιον εἴσω
Τρωσὶ μαχησόμενον· τὸν δ᾽ οὐχ ὑποδέξομαι αὖτις
οἶκαδε νοστήσαντα δόμον Πηλήϊον εἴσω.
ὄφρα δέ μοι ζώει καὶ ὁρᾷ φάος ἠελίοιο,
ἄχνυται, οὐδέ τί οἱ δύναμαι χραισμῆσαι ἰοῦσα.
κούρην ἣν ἄρα οἱ γέρας ἔξελον υἷες Ἀχαιῶν,
τὴν ἄψ ἐκ χειρῶν ἕλετο κρείων Ἀγαμέμνων.

HOMER (90)

δῶκε: the subject is ‘he’ (Peleus).
ἀνατρέχω: I shoot up.
γουνός: hillock, ridge.
κορωνίς: curved.
ὄφρα: while.
οἱ = αὐτῷ.
κούρη = κόρη.
κρείων: lordly.
τραφέμεν: ‘to grow’.
ἔρνος: sapling.
ἀλωή: orchard.
νοστέω: I return.
φάος: light.
χραισμέω (+ Dative Case): I help.
γέρας: prize.
ἔξοχος: pre-eminent.
φυτόν: tree.
ἐπιπροΐημι: I send forth.
Πηλήϊος: of Peleus.
ἄχνυμαι: I am troubled.
ἄψ: back, away.

3. Answer **either** Section A **or** Section B in this question:- **[80]**

A.

(i) Translate into English:- (50)

'φαῦλοι γὰρ ἂν τῷ γε σῷ λόγῳ εἶεν τῶν ἡμιθέων ὅσοι ἐν Τροίᾳ τετελευτήκασιν οἵ τε ἄλλοι καὶ ὁ τῆς Θέτιδος υἱός, ὃς τοσοῦτον τοῦ κινδύνου κατεφρόνησεν παρὰ τὸ αἰσχρόν τι ὑπομεῖναι ὥστε, ἐπειδὴ εἶπεν ἡ μήτηρ αὐτῷ προθυμουμένῳ Ἕκτορα ἀποκτεῖναι, θεὸς οὖσα, οὑτωσί πως, ὡς ἐγὼ οἶμαι· "ὦ παῖ, εἰ τιμωρήσεις Πατρόκλῳ τῷ ἑταίρῳ τὸν φόνον καὶ Ἕκτορα ἀποκτενεῖς, αὐτὸς ἀποθανῇ — αὐτίκα γάρ τοι", φησί, "μεθ' Ἕκτορα πότμος ἑτοῖμος" — ὁ δὲ τοῦτο ἀκούσας τοῦ μὲν θανάτου καὶ τοῦ κινδύνου ὠλιγώρησε, πολὺ δὲ μᾶλλον δείσας τὸ ζῆν κακὸς ὢν καὶ τοῖς <u>φίλοις</u> μὴ τιμωρεῖν, "αὐτίκα", φησί, "τεθναίην, δίκην ἐπιθεὶς τῷ ἀδικοῦντι, ἵνα μὴ ἐνθάδε <u>μένω</u> καταγέλαστος παρὰ νηυσὶ κορωνίσιν ἄχθος ἀρούρης." '

THE INTELLECTUAL REVOLUTION

(ii) Answer **any three** of the following questions. They carry ten marks each:- (30)

(*a*) Outline Socrates' views on death. Why does he refer to Homeric heroes in his defence?

(*b*) Identify Socrates' prosecutors and the charges that they brought against him.

(*c*) Write a short note on the Sophists. In what ways does Socrates think that he differs from them?

(*d*) Describe what a typical encounter with Socrates might have been like, based on your understanding of his philosophical method.

(*e*) If you had been one of those judging Socrates at his trial, how would you have voted? Explain your answer.

(*f*) Write a short note on **any two** of the following:-
Leon of Salamis; the Dikasts; Socrates as prytanis.

(*g*) Explain the case of φίλοις and the mood of μένω underlined in the passage above.

OR

B.

(i) Translate into English:- (50)

μήτηρ δ᾽ αὖθ᾽ ἑτέρωθεν ὀδύρετο δάκρυ χέουσα,
κόλπον ἀνιεμένη , ἑτέρηφι δὲ μαζὸν ἀνέσχε·
καί μιν δάκρυ χέουσ᾽ ἔπεα πτερόεντα προσηύδα·
‘Ἕκτορ, τέκνον ἐμόν, τάδε τ᾽ αἴδεο καί μ᾽ ἐλέησον
αὐτήν, εἴ ποτέ τοι λαθικηδέα μαζὸν ἐπέσχον·
τῶν μνῆσαι, φίλε τέκνον, ἄμυνε δὲ δήϊον ἄνδρα
τείχεος ἐντὸς ἐών, μηδὲ πρόμος ἵστασο τούτῳ,
σχέτλιος· εἴ περ γάρ σε κατακτάνῃ, οὔ σ᾽ ἔτ᾽ ἔγωγε
κλαύσομαι ἐν λεχέεσσι, φίλον θάλος, ὃν τέκον αὐτή,
οὐδ᾽ ἄλοχος πολύδωρος· ἄνευθε δέ σε μέγα νῶϊν
᾽Αργείων παρὰ νηυσὶ κύνες ταχέες κατέδονται.’
ὣς τώ γε κλαίοντε προσαυδήτην φίλον υἱόν,
πολλὰ λισσομένω· οὐδ᾽ Ἕκτορι θυμὸν ἔπειθον,
ἀλλ᾽ ὅ γε μίμν᾽ ᾽Αχιλῆα πελώριον ἆσσον ἰόντα.

A WORLD OF HEROES

(ii) Answer **any three** of the following questions. They carry ten marks each:- (30)

(*a*) Explain the immediate context of the passage above from Book 22 of the *Iliad*. What is the situation, and who are involved?

(*b*) Within Book 22 of the *Iliad*, how does Homer arouse sympathy for Hektor as he approaches his death?

(*c*) Outline the role of Athene in Book 22 of the *Iliad*.

(*d*) Comment briefly on the character of Akhilleus as presented in Book 22 of the *Iliad*.

(*e*) In your view, does Homer make effective use of similes? Support your answer with reference to similes that you have encountered in Book 22 of the *Iliad*.

(*f*) Write a short note on **any two** of the following:-
Patroklos; Peleus; Alexandros.

(*g*) Scan the **first line** of the passage above. Mark the quantities and name the metre.

4. Answer **any two** of the following questions. (Each question carries thirty marks):- **[60]**

(i) Give an account of the main events that led up to the outbreak of the Peloponnesian War in 431 BC. Explain what, in your opinion, the single most important cause of the war was.

(ii) Write notes on **any two** of the following:-

Pylos and Sphacteria; Brasidas; Arginusae; Parmenio.

(iii) Thebes enjoyed a period of dominance over Greece between 371 and 362 BC. Identify **three** significant events in this period and explain their importance. In your view, why did Thebes' dominance come to an end?

(iv) Outline the key components of the Spartan system of government. In your opinion, what was its greatest strength, and what was its greatest weakness?

(v) In your view, do the Homeric epics deserve to be highly regarded today? Support your answer with reference to **both** the *Iliad* **and** the *Odyssey*.

(vi) What were Plato's **three** greatest achievements, in your opinion? Justify your choices.

(vii) Outline the identifying characteristics of these three styles of ancient Greek vase-painting: **(a)** Geometric, **(b)** Black Figure, and **(c)** Red Figure. Which of these styles is your favourite? Support your choice with reference to **one** specific vase.

(viii) Having looked at Photographs **A**, **B** and **C** below, answer **any two** of the following questions:-

(*a*) Name the building to which the relief sculpture in Photograph **A** originally belonged. Comment briefly on the composition of the sculpture and the artistic skill involved in executing this work of art.

(*b*) To what period does the statue in Photograph **B** belong? Discuss the elements of this statue that are typical of this period.

(*c*) What type of building is shown in Photograph **C**? Identify its main features and briefly explain how these features relate to the function of the space.

A



B



C



Acknowledgements

Images

Page 10 (A): https://www.britannica.com/topic/Lapith
Page 10 (B): https://www.theacropolismuseum.gr/en/content/korai-acropolis
Page 11 (C): https://www.unescoworldheritage.net/greece/sanctuary-of-asklepios-at-epidaurus/

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Leaving Certificate – Higher Level

Ancient Greek

Monday 21 June
Morning 9.30 – 12.30